

Voluntary Report – Voluntary - Public Distribution

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Report Name: Overview of Israeli Soybean Market - 2025

Country: Israel

Post: Tel Aviv

Report Category: Oilseeds and Products

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Report Highlights:

FAS/Tel Aviv (Post) forecasts Israel's soybean imports in marketing year (MY) 2025/26 (October-September) to decrease slightly from the previous marketing year due to a decline in demand. Currently, almost no soybeans are imported from the United States, as 70 percent originate from Brazil. Soybean meal is used by the Israeli feed industry as a major source of protein, most of which comes from Argentina. Soybean oil consumption in MY 2025/26 is forecasted at 56 thousand metric tons (TMT), of which half will be imported.

Seeds

In Israel, there is no domestic production of soybeans. Limited arable land and tight supply of irrigated water precludes production. As farmers prefer to cultivate other crops, all soybeans are imported. This situation is not expected to change, and Israel will remain dependent on soybean imports, as well as most all other grains and oilseeds.

Post forecasts Israel's soybean imports in MY 2025/26 at 280 TMT, slightly down from the previous marketing year. Post attributes the decrease in imports to the reduction in domestic production of soybean oil. Israel's domestic soybean oil production costs are higher than other sources abroad, which has led to the shutdown of all but one domestic crushing facility.

Meals

Post forecasts Israel's soybean meal production in MY 2025/26 around 200 TMT, the same as the previous year, despite a minor decrease in domestic production of soybean oil due to high production costs. Based on the assumption that poultry, dairy, meat and aquaculture farm sectors stay at their current sizes, overall feed use of soybean meal is not expected to grow. Expectations are that in the coming years, local crushing will decline, and less meal will be available on the market; Post estimates that more meals will be imported.

Soybean meal is used as the major source of protein in feed rations, mainly by the poultry sector, but also by the dairy sector. The limited size of the local poultry sector and the government's regulations for production quotas of egg and dairy preclude growth of these sectors. Poultry production is limited due to the lack of growing facilities which are expensive to construct. Due to the limited growth of the livestock sectors in Israel, Post is estimating almost no changes in soybean meal consumption in the coming years.

Oil

Due to Israel's limited soybean crushing capacity, Israel continues to rely on imports of soybean oil, as well as other vegetable oils. There is limited crushing capacity in Israel due to Israel's high production costs which make imported oil more lucrative. Israeli consumers prefer canola oil and more healthier oils such as olive oil. The availability of soybean oil in most of the big retail chains is usually limited. Furthermore, the government has import tariffs on oil to protect local production.

SOYBEANS:

Production, Supply and Demand Data Statistics:

Oilseed, Soybean Market Year Begins	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026	
	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025	
Israel	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Area Planted (1000 HA)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	13	13	11	11	14	12
Production (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
MY Imports (1000 MT)	285	285	320	284	350	280
Total Supply (1000 MT)	298	298	331	295	364	292
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Crush (1000 MT)	260	260	290	256	320	255
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	15	15	15	15	15	15
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	12	12	12	12	12	12
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	287	287	317	283	347	282
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	11	11	14	12	17	10
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	298	298	331	295	364	292
Yield (MT/HA)	0	0	0	0	0	0
(1000 HA) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

PRODUCTION

Israel does not cultivate soybeans and is not expected to do so in the future due to limited land and water resources. As such, Post is forecasting Israel's soybean production for MY 2025/26 at zero.

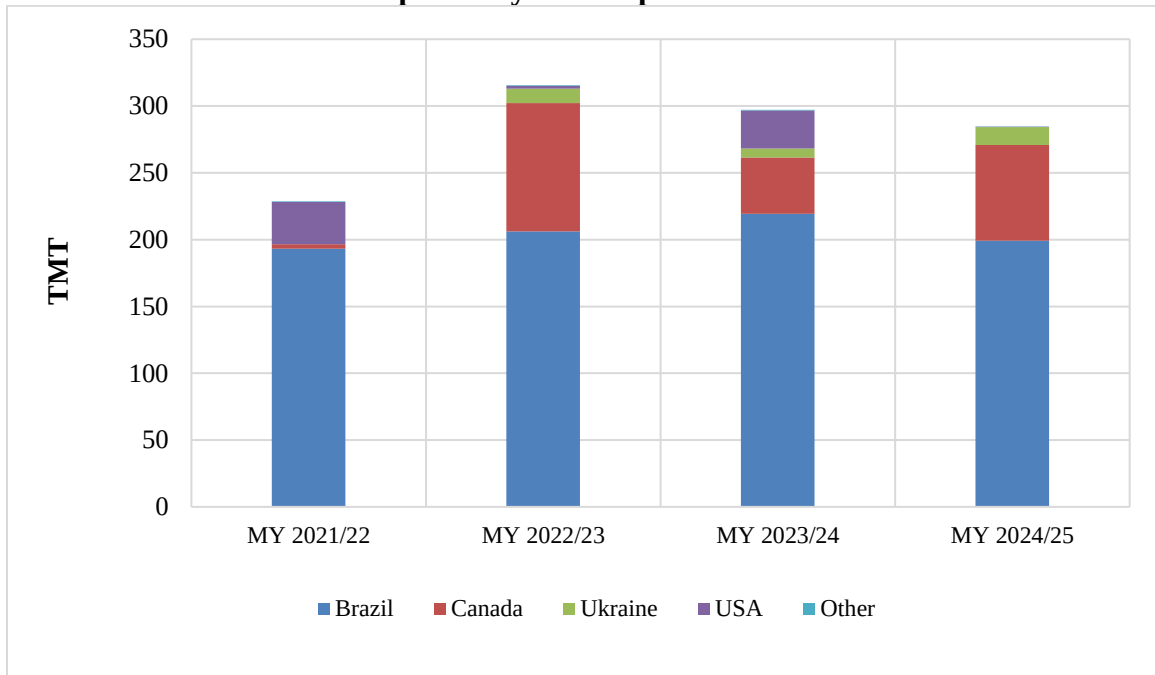
CONSUMPTION

Post forecasts Israel's soybean consumption in MY 2025/26 slightly down at 282 TMT, due to a reduction in domestic crushing over the years (because of the high production costs which led to the closure of many crushing facilities). Post forecasts that in the coming years, the crushing of soybeans will gradually continue to decrease and will be replaced by imports of soybean oil and soybean meal. However, there is a government incentive to keep some crushing capacity operational for food security reasons.

TRADE

Post forecasts Israel's soybean imports in MY 2025/26 at 280 TMT, slightly down from MY 2024/25 figures. Israel's main suppliers of soybeans in MY 2024/25 were Brazil (almost 70 percent), followed by Canada and Ukraine (see Graph 1).

Graph 1: Soybean Exports to Israel



Source: Trade Data Monitor

Israel is a relatively small importer of soybeans and uses soybeans mainly for crushing, but also for protein products such as tofu and soy milk. As Israel continues to decrease its domestic crushing, importing soybean oil will most likely be more lucrative; as such, Post expects imports of soybeans to gradually decline.

STOCKS

Post forecasts MY 2025/26 soybean stocks down at 10 TMT, as currently there is only one crushing facility left in the country which is responsible for most of the stock.¹

TARIFFS

There are no tariffs or import quotas for soybeans.

¹ www.tadmir.co.il/he/node/118

SOYBEAN MEAL

Production, Supply and Demand Data Statistics:

Meal, Soybean Market Year Begins Israel	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026	
	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	260	260	290	256	320	255
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.7769	0.7885	0.7759	0.7813	0.775	0.7843
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	67	67	18	20	43	20
Production (1000 MT)	202	205	225	200	248	200
MY Imports (1000 MT)	249	321	350	362	360	380
Total Supply (1000 MT)	518	593	593	582	651	600
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	500	573	550	562	600	580
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	500	573	550	562	600	580
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	18	20	43	20	51	20
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	518	593	593	582	651	600
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

PRODUCTION

Post forecasts Israel's soybean meal production in MY 2025/26 at 200 TMT. All soybean meal is produced by one crushing facility, Solbar. In the past, additional larger crushing facilities were operating in Israel, and the domestic production of soybean meal was larger.²

CONSUMPTION

Post forecasts Israel's soybean meal consumption in MY 2025/26 at 580 TMT, an increase of 3.2 percent from the previous marketing year, due to the poultry sector returning to normal activity which was slowed down due to the conflict in the North which affected the poultry sector. As egg and milk production is regulated by production boards which operate to eliminate production surplus and market shortages, the feed consumption in the country in the coming years is expected to have only minor changes due to population growth.

Soybean meal is a major ingredient in the animal feed industry and serves as the main protein source in feed meals for poultry (20-35 percent of the meal) but is also used as feed for dairy cattle (10-18 percent), feeder cattle (8-12 percent), and aquaculture (15-40 percent), depending on the variety of fish. The average monthly consumption of soybean meal is estimated at 48 TMT.

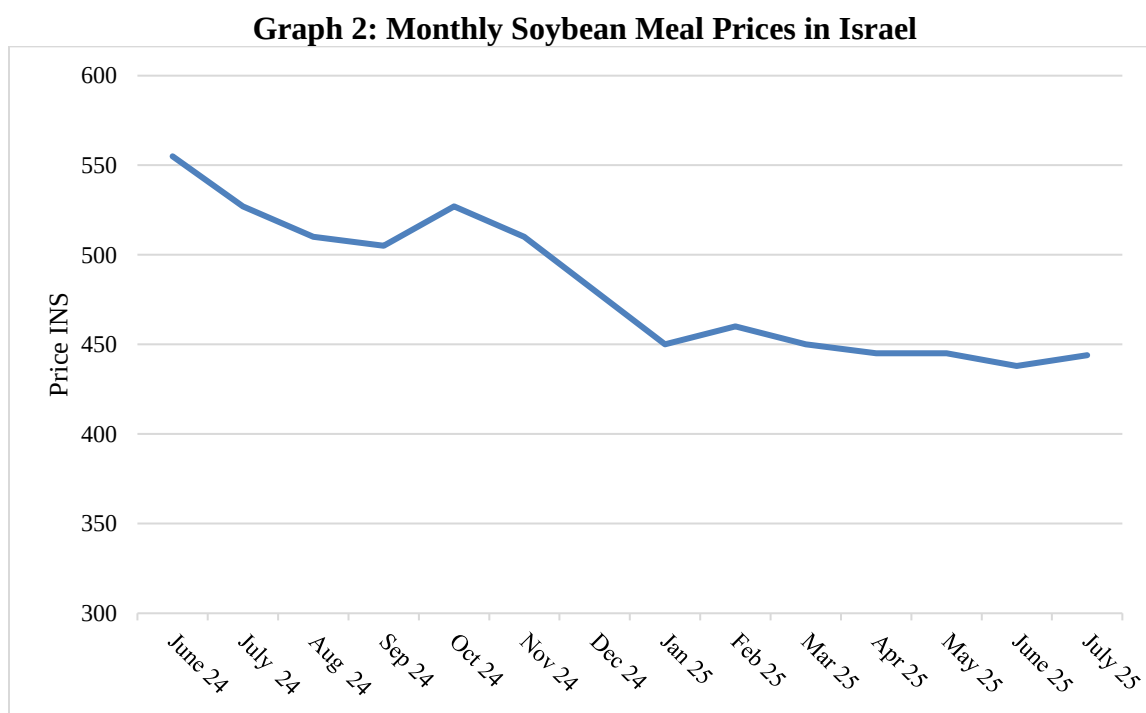
Eight feed mills control the local milling industry. They specialize in feed for the different livestock and aquaculture industries and produce hundreds of different feed rations for each of the different growing stages. The feed mills are located across the country with branches located around the core consumption areas. In addition, there are feed centers located in many of the

² www.tadmir.co.il/he/node/118

large dairy farms, most of which are located and operated by local farming communities (i.e., Kibbutzim) which are communal feed mills. These Kibbutzim purchase the feed for the meals from importers and mix them to produce feed for livestock. There are around 926 dairy farms located around the country, most of which have a local feed center. The large number of feed centers makes it difficult to estimate feed stock.

There are also around 2,460 poultry farms (layers, broilers and turkey), most of which are located in the northern parts of the country. These farms tend to purchase ready-to-use meal from the big feed mills.

From June 2024 until July 2025, domestic soybean meal prices declined by 20 percent (see Graph 2). Some of the price decrease is attributed to the strong Israeli shekel which appreciated against the U.S. dollar by 9.12 percent between June 2024 to July 2025. The price of feed is one of the largest expenses for livestock farmers. Despite the decrease in feed prices over the past year, the consumer price of meat and other animal products did not change; as a result, total consumption of these products did not increase.



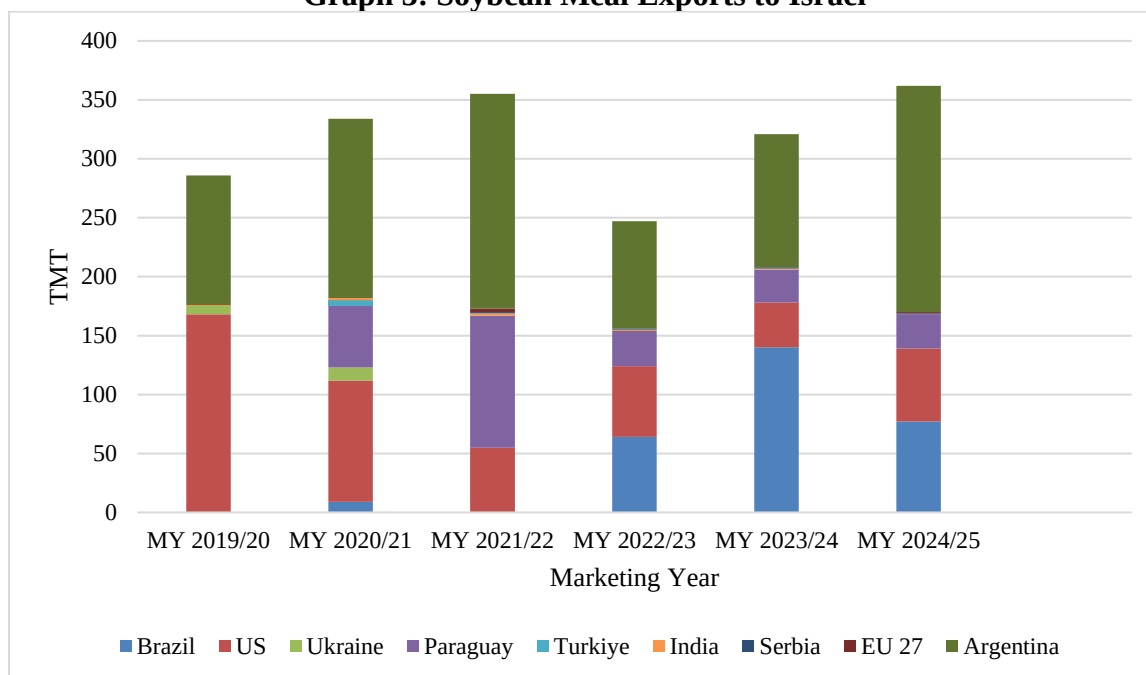
Source: Israeli Cattle Breeders Association

TRADE

Post forecasts Israel's soybean meal imports in MY 2025/26 at 380 TMT, up five percent from MY 2024/25. This is attributed mainly to the return of normal activity for many poultry and dairy farms located in the northern parts of the country which were affected by the conflict with Hezbollah in the north. Israel's main suppliers of soybean meal in MY 2024/25 were Argentina (53 percent) Brazil (21 percent), and the United States (17 percent). In the past six years, three

countries dominated exports to Israel—Argentina, the United States, and Brazil (see Graph 3). Israel imports from these three countries as they have trade agreements with them, allowing preference for reduced import tariffs. Israel is not an exporter of soybean meal and is not expected to export soybean meal in the future.

Graph 3: Soybean Meal Exports to Israel



Source: Trade Data Monitor; FAS research

STOCKS

For MY 2025/26, Post forecasts soybean meal stocks to remain stable at 20 TMT. Feed and grain stock is managed by the Israeli government but is not officially published. Post assumes that the Israeli government intends to keep some private sector crushing operational to have supply of soybean meal and oil in case there is a disruption in the international supply chain.

TARIFFS

Tariffs implemented on imported soybean meals are only applied to harmonized system (HS) code 2304 (oil cake and other solid residues derived from soybean oil extraction) (see Chart 1). They are placed as a protective measure to support the local industry. Post forecasts that if the local industry discontinues operations, these tariffs could be lifted.

Chart 1: HS Code Schedule of Tariffs for Soybeans

HS Code	Product	Tariff	Notes
120810	Flour and meals of oilseeds	Zero	
230250	Bran, sharps and other residues derived from leguminous plants	Zero	
2304	Oil cake and other solid residues derived from soybean oil extraction	7.5 percent general; 4.65 percent for the United States	A reduced tariff is provided for Brazil, Uruguay, Paraguay and Argentina.

SOYBEAN OIL

Production, Supply and Demand Data Statistics:

Oil, Soybean Market Year Begins Israel	2023/2024		2024/2025		2025/2026	
	Oct 2023		Oct 2024		Oct 2025	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	260	260	290	256	320	255
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.1846	0.1923	0.1828	0.1875	0.1844	0.1882
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	5	5	3	4	6	4
Production (1000 MT)	48	50	53	48	59	48
MY Imports (1000 MT)	10	9	10	6	10	8
Total Supply (1000 MT)	63	64	66	58	75	60
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	30	30	30	26	30	28
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	30	30	30	28	40	28
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	60	60	60	54	70	56
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	3	4	6	4	5	4
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	63	64	66	58	75	60
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

PRODUCTION

Post forecasts Israel's soybean oil production as unchanged for MY 2025/26 at 48 TMT.

Production is controlled by only one crushing facility. Despite the import tariff on soybean oil, it is still more attractive to import than to produce domestically. If the local crushing facility continues to operate, Post expects production to continue around levels of 4 TMT per month.

CONSUMPTION

Post forecasts soybean oil consumption to reach 56 TMT in MY 2025/26. Israeli consumers tend to prefer canola oil over soybean oil. In most food stores, the availability of soybean oil is limited due to consumer preference for canola oil. Post assumes that if there are no large-scale marketing programs for soybean oil, preference for canola oil will continue.

TRADE

Post forecasts Israel's soybean oil imports in MY 2025/26 at 8 TMT, slightly higher than MY 2024/25 figures as the hotel, restaurant, and institutional (HRI) sectors return to pre-October 7 activity. Most imports are from the EU (67 percent), Serbia (19 percent), and Ukraine (11 percent).

STOCKS

The Israeli government holds emergency food stocks which include vegetable oils. It is unclear which type of oil is being held, but due to consumer preference, it is likely that the stock is primarily canola oil. Post estimates stocks at 4 TMT which are found mainly in the importers and big retailers' warehouses.

TARRIFS

There is a general import tariff of 7.5 percent on importation of soybean oil used as a protective tax. Due to the Free Trade Agreement between Israel and the United States, the United States has a reduced tariff of 4.65 percent.

Attachments:

No Attachments.